

Philipp Hilbert. *Technical Product Manager, AI Neobank.*

Positioning, fintech PM with 13 years in regulated products, payments, insurance, and AI platforms, who knows where deterministic systems must stay in control.

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§ WHY KIRA

KIRA is doing the hard thing: building a financial superapp across payments, remittance, insurance, wealth, and trading in a region where regulatory fragmentation and financial rail complexity are the actual product constraints, not edge cases to handle later. The explicit expectation that a TPM shapes technical design, APIs, ledgering, failure handling, rather than just tracking delivery is the kind of scope I have worked in at every role. What is particularly sharp about this posting is the framing around AI: a means, not a goal, with clear evaluation, safeguards, and human oversight. That is not how most companies write it. *That precision about when AI should not be used is exactly the environment where my judgment compounds.*

§ AI-NATIVE STACK

Daily tools, not buzzwords.

- **Claude Code**, in-repo spec work and edge-case generation
- **GitHub Copilot**, assisted development across Python and SQL
- **Cursor**, context-heavy refactor and scaffolding sessions
- **Lovable**, rapid front-end prototyping before engineering picks up
- **n8n**, agentic workflow design and automation pipelines
- **GPT**, evaluation loops and structured prompt engineering
- **Framer**, design-weight prototypes and stakeholder walkthroughs
- **Gamma.app**, decision documents and roadmap communication

§ TECHNICAL ENVIRONMENT

Shipped with, not just listed.

Kubernetes, OpenShift, Docker, ArgoCD, GitOps rollout and rollback, Jenkins, CI/CD, GitLab, Azure DevOps, Python, Kotlin (Spring Boot), Django, REST APIs, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Kafka, Dagster, dbt, SQL, Git, across defence AI, public-sector analytics, insurance SaaS, and payments platforms, in production.

§ SIDE PROJECT

CONSTRUCT8 [GITHUB.COM/HILBERTP](https://github.com/HilbertP) →

Two-sided B2B marketplace matching construction firms with workers, built zero to one alone.

- Anonymity-until-payment model: neither side reveals identity until commitment is made, removing the headhunter cost from the hire.
 - WhatsApp and Telegram as the product surface, lowering onboarding friction to near zero for a non-app-native workforce.
 - LLM agents across the funnel so a single operator runs day-to-day matching and conversion.
 - Funnel and conversion analysis in SQL; directly transferable to KIRA's onboarding and activation metrics work.
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§ HOW I WOULD WORK AT KIRA

First weeks, concrete.

WEEK 1

Listen, map, find the gaps.

Shadow the payments and remittance vertical, map the existing API contracts and ledgering flows end to end, and identify where failure handling and reconciliation are underdocumented before touching the roadmap.

WEEK 2

Tighten the spec.

Work with engineering to surface the two or three design decisions currently deferred under uncertainty, failure modes, idempotency, limit enforcement, and produce clear trade-off documents for each.

WEEK 3+

Ship and close loops.

Take the clearest near-term deliverable through a full gate: technical design signed off, compliance requirements mapped, launch criteria agreed, and the first production release out the door.

I COVER LETTER

Dear KIRA Hiring Team,

I am applying for the Technical Product Manager role on the AI Neobank App. My background spans 13 years of product ownership in regulated domains, payments, insurance, defence AI, and public-sector data platforms, and I have always worked at the intersection of technical design and product delivery rather than on one side of that line. KIRA's framing of the role resonates precisely because it names the hard parts: ledgering, reconciliation, failure handling, regulatory rails, and the deliberate question of where AI improves an outcome versus where deterministic control must stay in place.

At Kvitt Payment Solutions, I built a mobile group-based P2P payments product from zero and took it to acquisition by Sparkasse inside the girocard ecosystem. That experience taught me that money correctness is not a quality attribute to be added late, it is the product. Users who are misled about the state of their funds, even briefly, do not return. At Scheidt & Bachmann's Fuel and Convenience Retail division, I moved research results into production across a matrix organisation in a fully SAFe setup, working directly across engineering, compliance, and operations on POS and forecourt payment systems. The coordination overhead in a regulated, multi-team environment is a product problem, and I treat it as one.

On the insurance side, I shipped the Claims Center at EMIL Group from concept to production with no precedent, cut time-to-market for new insurance product launches from months to under a week, and restructured an 18-person delivery organisation that was losing its senior engineers. At KIRA, the alignment challenge across engineering, design, compliance, operations, treasury, and finance is the same class of problem at greater scale and with higher regulatory stakes. I know how to make that kind of multi-function alignment happen without friction accumulating into delay.

On AI: at Rohde & Schwarz I was the product owner for an internal AI and data platform for the FCAS European defence programme, managing a cross-functional team of 15 engineers and data scientists. I redirected strategy based on instrumented workflow analysis, the beautiful UI-led flow recorded exactly zero clicks, and championed GitOps delivery that took rollout time from days to 30 minutes. The lesson I carry from that project is that AI feature value must be

evaluated against a concrete baseline, with observable outcomes and a clear fallback when the model is wrong. That is the same bar I would apply to every AI feature on KIRA's neobank stack.

I am available at short notice, comfortable working across time zones in distributed teams, and ready to move through your assessment and interview process quickly. I would welcome the chance to discuss the payments or remittance vertical in more depth.

Best regards, *Philipp Hilbert*

II CURRICULUM VITAE

§ BEARING

Product manager with 13 years of ownership in regulated industries, fintech payments, insurance, defence AI, and public-sector analytics, who covers strategy through technical design and production delivery. I work directly with engineering on API contracts, failure handling, and system architecture; I build regulatory requirements into the product rather than treating compliance as a downstream review; and I apply AI where evaluation supports it, not by default. Relocating or remote, available at short notice, no visa requirement in the EU.

§ WHAT I CAN DO

AI Products and Tooling: LLM agents, agentic workflows, prompt and context engineering, evaluation loops, human-in-the-loop design, AI governance, EU AI Act, Explainable AI (XAI); full prototyping with Claude Code, GitHub Copilot, Cursor and Lovable.

Payments and fintech: P2P mobile payments (zero to acquisition), POS and forecourt payment systems, PSP integration, girocard ecosystem, payment flow edge-case handling.

Insurance and regulated platform: B2B SaaS platform for insurers, reinsurers and brokers; claims lifecycle; KYC and compliance requirements; GDPR; Deputy IT Security Officer.

Product Management: continuous discovery, product vision and roadmap, prioritisation, MVP and PoC definition, A/B testing, user research and interviews, go-to-market support, OKRs (Objectives and Key Results).

Product Ownership: requirements engineering, user stories, acceptance criteria, backlog refinement, sprint planning, velocity and burndown, UAT, Jira, Confluence, Figma, Miro.

Agile and Scaled Delivery: Scrum, Kanban, SAgile (Scaled Agile Framework), ART (agile release train), PI planning.

Technical Environments: Kubernetes, OpenShift, Docker, ArgoCD, GitOps, Jenkins, CI/CD, REST APIs, Python, Kotlin, Django, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Kafka, Dagster, dbt, SQL.

Analytics and data: ETL (extract, transform, load), funnel and churn analysis, KPI definition, Dagster, dbt, PostgreSQL, Matomo, MicroStrategy.

Stakeholder and Leadership: cross-functional team leadership, C-level reporting, workshop facilitation, conflict resolution, change management.

§ PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

ROHDE & SCHWARZ · PRODUCT MANAGER · DEFENCE AI AND DATA PLATFORM 2024-2025

Internal AI and data platform for the FCAS European programme. Led 15+ engineers and data scientists; championed GitOps with ArgoCD cutting rollout from days to 30 minutes; redirected strategy on instrumented workflow data, increasing pipeline runs 200%. Kubernetes, OpenShift, ArgoCD, Dagster, Python.

BUNDESAGENTUR FÜR ARBEIT · PRODUCT MANAGER · PUBLIC-SECTOR DATA PLATFORM 2023-2024

National labour-market analytics platform. Integrated test automation into Jenkins, introduced Dagster and dbt saving 75% of time per data update, migrated bare-metal to containers. Deputy IT Security Officer. PostgreSQL, dbt, Jenkins, Kubernetes.

CLINET PLATFORMS · PRODUCT OWNER · HEALTHCARE MOBILE APP 2023

Cut roadmap to top 10% of features against agreed success measures; user acceptance rose fivefold. Delivered CGM hospital information system (KIS) interface reducing digital anamnesis from 30 minutes to 5. iOS, Android, REST APIs.

EMIL GROUP · PRODUCT MANAGER · INSURANCE B2B SAAS PLATFORM 2022

Restructured 18-person delivery organisation into three lean teams; attrition from near-total exodus to one departure. Shipped Claims Center zero to production; cut time-to-market for new insurance product launches from months to under one week.

SCHEIDT & BACHMANN · PRODUCT OWNER INTEGRATION · RETAIL PAYMENTS AND POS 2021-2022

Payments and forecourt systems. Moved research into production in a fully SAFe setup with agile release trains and PI planning.

BUNDESDRUCKEREI · PRODUCT OWNER (INTERIM) · GOVERNMENT SECURE
DATA PLATFORM 2021

Data structures and identity management for Robert Koch Institute programmes DIM and DESH.

AOK ITSCARE · PRODUCT OWNER (PROXY) · HEALTH INSURANCE B2B
PLATFORM 2019-2020

Migrated legacy procurement webshop to Shopware for three AOK insurers and ~20,000 employees; still in production. Jira, Shopware.

ENERCON · PROJECT LEAD · WIND ENERGY IT MODERNISATION 2019

Full site IT modernisation end to end.

WALDBURG-ZEIL KLINIKEN · PRODUCT OWNER · CLINICAL HEALTHCARE
NETWORK 2017-2018

Wifi infrastructure rollout across nine hospitals.

§ FOUNDER & EARLY-STAGE EXPERIENCE

CONSTRUCT8 · FOUNDER AND PRODUCT MANAGER · CONSTRUCTION
STAFFING MARKETPLACE 2025-2026

Zero to one: two-sided B2B marketplace, anonymity-until-payment model, LLM agents across the funnel, conversion analysis in SQL.

QCRYPT AG · CO-FOUNDER AND PRODUCT OWNER · QUANTUM-SECURE
ENCRYPTION 2016-2021

Hardware and software for enterprise quantum-secure encryption. Shipped three-layer product installing in under two minutes. Later Chair of the board.

SMART SOIL TECHNOLOGIES · CO-FOUNDER, CDO AND CFO ·
NANOTECHNOLOGY AND AGRICULTURE 2018-2021

Took fertiliser product from laboratory to investor rounds; owned financial planning and investor reporting.

KVITT PAYMENT SOLUTIONS · FOUNDER AND CFO · FINTECH P2P
PAYMENTS 2013-2018

Mobile group-based P2P payments platform. Built from zero, acquired and operated by Sparkasse inside the girocard ecosystem.

§ LANGUAGES

German, native. English, C2.

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TRUE NORTH · APPLICATION PACKAGE · BJAK

